Michael Tueting

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Education

University of St.Gallen, Switzerland
Ph.D. Economics and Finance, 2020 to 2026 (expected)
Thesis committee: Roland Hodler, Beatrix Eugster, Ferdinand Rauch, Adam Storeygard

Tufts University, United States
Visiting Ph.D. student, August 2023 to June 2024
Hosted by Adam Storeygard

Massachusetts Institute of Technology, United States
Non-degree coursework, 2023 to 2024
International Trade I & II (attended without formal credit)

Leibniz University Hannover, Germany
M.Sc. Economics, graduated with distinction, 2018 to 2020
B.Sc. Economics, 2015 to 2018

Fields

Primary Fields: International Trade, Spatial Economics
Secondary Fields: Economic Development, Environmental Economics

Job Market Paper

Climate Change, Income Inequality, and Migration in a Spatial Economy
This paper examines how income shapes individuals' migration responses to climate change and the resulting aggregate welfare implications. Standard quantitative spatial models predict that workers migrate away from climate-affected regions, thereby mitigating welfare losses; however, these models often fail to capture differences in migration behavior across the income distribution. Micro-level evidence suggests that low-income households often do not migrate despite significant potential gains from relocating. To reconcile these insights, I develop a dynamic quantitative spatial model that incorporates both monetary and non-monetary migration costs. Given decreasing marginal utility of income, these costs generate lower mobility among low-income workers. Climate change affects the model economy through two channels: first, by impacting agricultural productivity and resulting in income losses at the lower end of the income distribution; second, indirectly, by increasing the relative burden of monetary migration costs as average incomes decline. Calibration relies on aggregate migration flows. Simulations for Brazil (2010-2100) indicate that without migration, climate change reduces expected average lifetime utility by 2.2%. Migration at calibrated costs reduces welfare losses to 1.7%. Migration also mitigates the widening of regional and sectoral inequalities that climate change would otherwise induce.

Working Papers

Skill Supply, Firm Size, and Economic Development (with Charles Gottlieb and Markus Poschke). In *World Development Report 2024 Background Papers*, World Bank.

Papers in Progress

Infrastructure, language, and the making of a common market (with Roland Hodler and Paul Schaudt).

Teaching	**University of St.Gallen, Switzerland** Political Economics, teaching fellow for Professor Hodler, 2021 to 2022 Economics of Climate Change, teaching fellow for Professor Eisenbarth, 2023 Public Sector Economics, teaching fellow for Professor Hodler, 2022 to 2025 Development Economics, teaching fellow for Professor Hodler, 2020 to 2025 Failed States and Nation Building, teaching fellow for Professor Hodler, 2024 to 2025 Data Science, teaching fellow for Professor Matter, 2021 to 2023 **Leibniz University Hannover, Germany** Introduction to Macroeconomics, teaching fellow for Professor Gassebner, 2017 to 2019 Operations Management, teaching fellow for Professor Helber, 2017
Research	**University of St.Gallen, Switzerland** Research assistant for Roland Hodler, 2020 to 2025 **The Bayelsa State Oil & Environmental Commission, Nigeria/UK** Research assistance, 2021 **Leibniz University Hannover, Germany** Research assistant for Richard Bluhm, 2018 to 2020
Conferences and Seminars	**2025:** Development Economics Network Switzerland (Zürich, Switzerland), VfS Annual Conference (Cologne, Germany), Political Economy of Global Development (Stuttgart, Germany) **2024:** Tufts Economics and Public Policy Workshop (Medford, United States) **2023:** North American Meeting of the Urban Economics Association (Toronto, Canada), European Meeting of the Urban Economics Association (Milan, Italy), German Development Economics Conference (Dresden, Germany), Annual Congress of the Swiss Society of Economics and Statistics (Neuchâtel, Switzerland), Warwick Economics PhD Conference (Coventry, UK), Young Swiss Economists Meeting (Zürich, Switzerland)
Grants	**Mobi.Doc**, University of St. Gallen, 2023 (CHF 47,333) Mobility grant that funded my research visit at Tufts University **Google Cloud Research Credits Program** (USD 1,015) Provided cloud computing resources for my job market paper
Languages	German (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)
Skills	**Programming:** Python, R, Matlab, C++, JavaScript; Git/GitHub, Docker **Geospatial:** ArcGIS, GRASS GIS, QGIS, Google Earth Engine **Machine Learning:** Keras, TensorFlow